The efforts in this direction were dismally erratic and ineffective in Pakistan's strategy. Despite successful military operation in Swat, the dreaded Maulvi Fazlullah could not be captured or killed and resultantly he became a menace operating from across the border. Similarly, Baitullah Mehsud, the founder and TTP Chief was not killed by the Pakistani forces, and ultimately, the US drone attack eliminated him. Further, the US drone twice hit Hakimullah Mehsud, the next TTP Chief in 2012, but he escaped and kept controlling the organisation for almost 2 years until he was eliminated in a drone attack in November 2013. The absence of CT strategy and persistent lack of coordinated and coherent counter-terrorism measures had been enabling the terrorists. This was a grave threat to Pakistan, where not only valuable lives were perishing cheaply at the hands of terrorists, but social and economic fabrics were disrupted and destroyed by them with the help of their supporters and sympathisers operating in urban centres across Pakistan.

While Pakistan was still grappling with this scourge, another group started spreading in many parts of the country. Footprints of the dreaded Islamic State (IS), also known by the acronym Daish, became visible, which attracted the religious extremists and some groups of TTP who joined it. Hafiz Saeed, TTP leader in Orakzai Agency of FATA, became the head of IS in Pakistan. In October 2014, six top commanders of TTP, including its now defunct spokesperson Shahidullah Shahid, announced their allegiance to IS's caliph Abu Bakr Al-Baghdadi Al Qureshi Al-Hussaini. The Taliban spokesperson said that he, along with TTP chief for Orakzai Agency Saeed Khan, TTP chief for Kurram Agency Daulat Khan, TTP's Khyber Agency chief Fateh Gul Zaman, TTP's Peshawar chief Mufti Hassan and TTP's Hangu chief Khalid Mansoor, announced their allegiance to Abu Bakr Al-Baghdadi (*Dawn*, 2014).

In October 2014, the provincial government of Balochistan had conveyed a confidential report to the federal government and law enforcement agencies warning of increased footprints of IS in Pakistan. According to this report, IS claimed to have recruited a huge 10–12,000 followers from the Hangu and Kurram Agency tribal areas. It was a highly exaggerated number. The presence of IS was also evident in cities through wall chalkings and the distribution of literature. Locally published Urdu literature of IS was distributed in a number of cities including Lahore, Karachi, Khanewal and Peshawar (*Dawn*, 2014).